Chapter 10

Tug-of-War

SUMMARY. |'Oma |'Oma, a Ju|'hoan man, had the first cattle and herded them alone, but they had no kraal. A Black man came and asked whose cattle they were. The Ju|'hoan man said they were his, but agreed to herd them back to the village with the Black man to spend the night. One of the cows had given birth, so the Black man said, "Let's milk her and taste the milk." |'Oma |'Oma was afraid of the cow, so he asked the Black man to tie her up with a leather riem. The Black man told |'Oma |'Oma to wash the pot so they could cook the milk and eat it together. But |'Oma |'Oma refused, saying the other should drink the milk and he would scrape the pot. Then |'Oma |'Oma gave the Black man a leather riem that was tied to a piece of string. The two of them pulled on its opposite ends. It soon broke, and the Black man got the riem, while |'Oma |'Oma got the string. The Black man said he would keep the cows and the Ju|'hoan man would be his servant. |'Oma |'Oma had to go off and eat little things like the three kinds of raisin berries, and the Black man began to cultivate sorghum and maize and ate them along with beef and milk.

SPEAKER. *Di‖xao Pari |Kai*

RECORDED. Kauri, Botswana, 1971

TRANSCRIBED BY. *Tsamkxao Fanni |Ui, Hacky Kgami Gcao, |Ai!ae Fridrick |Kunta*

khama ha n|a o jua koh koe du te
because he was certainly a person who did thus and
ka ha ku koe du ‖'akaa ha tse
2 *and he did thus and then he*

sa goba
and the black person
ha n|a ko gumi sa koh kxaina o ha hisi
he (|'Oma |'Oma) certainly said cattle first belonged to him
khama ha hin koh o ǁ'aixa
because he was a rich person
koa ha ǁama
from his origin
ha koh o ǁ'aiha
he was a rich person
khama ha te, ha hin tsi o haa, ha n|a u ha hin he
because he, he was that, he went that side
te ka ha o ǁ'aiha ǁ'akaa ha tsi g|ae
and when he was a rich man he came
te gumi hi n|a koh koara !hua
but the cattle certainly had no kraal
ha tsi g|ae
he came
ha tsi g|ae te sa tsi g|ae du hi te du hi te du hi te ha o n|e'e te du hi te
he came and they came and herded the cattle, and herded them, and herded them and he alone herded them
iin, te tsi g|ae n|ang !hari
yes, and went to sit in the shade
te ha goba n|ui ǁama te tsi g|ae, goba
and a black man came there, a black man
"tcisa ke re o tcisa o hajoe gasi?"
"whose things (animals) are these?"
te ha koh "tcisa o mi gasi"
and he said "these are my things"
"ihin, te ka ka o a gasi, re
"yes, and if they are yours, why
mtsa du hi n|ang ǁ'a mtsa te du ua hi ko tju|ho?"
not herd them so that we can drive them back to the village?"
sa, sa kua zaihan khoe
they, they soon agreed
kua du hi te du hi te tani ua hi ko tju|ho
soon herded them and herded them and brought them back to the village
te ka sa ku tani ua hi ko tju|ho
and when they brought them to the village
sa n|uia to'a ǁ'a ha kua !oa ha te ko–kana ha n|ui te ǁamm–
his colleague there soon told him and said–because one of them had given birth–
kua !oa ha te ko, "haa mtsa ǂaeh tzao tca ke
soon told him and said, "you, let's go milk this thing

n|ang tsi g|ae tsaahn”
and then go taste it”
ha ko ”ee, to’a, n|ang mtsa u ǂaeh tzao”
he said ”yes, go, let’s go arrive and milk”
te ha ko, sa ku g|ae te ha ko
and he said, they went and he said
”mi m ku mi, ha, haa ǁ’ang ha, mi m ku koaq ha”
”I’m going to, I, you, you tie it up, I’m afraid of it”
(|Ui ma, a m gǂom, itsa gǂom g!hoo, gǂom i tzisi n|ang g!hoo)
(|Ui ma, you be quiet, you two be quiet, silence your mouths and sit down)
”mi ku koaq ha, n|a a ǁ’ang ha”
”I’m afraid of it, now you tie it up”
haa |’Oma |’Oma ha n|a koh koaq ha
|’Oma |’Oma certainly was afraid of it
he ku ko ha u he ha ǁ’ang ha
and he said the other one should go and tie him up
ha tsi g|ae gu xore te tsi g|ae ǁ’ang ha
he came and got a riem and came and tied it up
te n|ang te tzao
and sat down and milked
tzao ha tzao ha te tia ka tzao g!a’in tan
milked it and milked it and milked the dish full
ka g!a’in te ha ǁama
it was full and he came from there
sa tsi !’an te ha ko, ha |’Oma |’Oma ne !oa ha te ko
they two came up and he said, |’Oma |’Oma told him, saying
”ǁka kxoa to’a n!un,
”wash the pot that is standing there,
n|ang n|oaq
and cook
n|ang mtsa, mtsa tsaahn ”
so we two, we two can taste it”
te ha ko
and he said
ha goba n!au n!a’an ko ”a re
the old black man said ”are you
a re, tca ke re a re !’han wa?”
do you, do you know this thing?”
”’In-in, mi m |oa !’han tca ke,
”no, I don’t know this thing,
mia o |’Oma |’Oma m |oa !’han ka”
I, |’Oma |’Oma, certainly do not know it”

”ha n|a a kho”
”now you wait”
te ha ka
and he
haa |’Oma |’Oma ǁka ka ǁka ka kxo te ǁka ka te sa kua n|oaq
|’Oma |’Oma washed and washed the pot and washed it and they soon cooked
te ka kua tsi g|ae koe buxobe
and it soon became like porridge
sa kua ǂhoe ka te n!ang ka te ka ǂa’u
they two quickly took it off the fire and set it down and it cooled
te sa
and they two
sa n|ui ko ”te a re ca hoe ka mtsa ’m?”
the other one said, ”will you come so the two of us can eat?”
te ha ko ’in-in”, ha |’Oma |’Oma kua !xau, ko ”’in-in,
and he said ” uh-uh,” |’Oma |’Oma quickly refused, and said ”uh-uh,
’m tca to’a n|ang ’m ǁ’a a te nǂai nǁo’ma mi”
”eat that, eat that and let me scrape the pot”
sa ’m te ha to’a kua ’m te ’m te ’m te ’m te ’m te kua gu kxo n!ang te
they ate and that one quickly ate and ate and ate and ate and soon took the rest of the pot
kxo te |’an ha
and gave the pot to him
ha kua, ha n|a n|ang te nǁo’m ka
he quickly, he certainly sat down and scraped it
nǁo’m te nǁo’m te nǁo’m te nǁo’m te sa kua tuih gǁa
scraped and scraped and scraped and scraped and they two soon stood up
te ha kua ko
and he quickly said
”gu xore
”take the riem
n|ang mi gu !hui”; haa |’Oma |’Oma n|a gu !hui
and let me take the string”; |’Oma |’Oma certainly took the string
te ha goba gu xore
and the black man took the riem
te sa kua
and they soon
ǁhaia khoe ko ǁ’a !huia kahinto’a
pulled on opposite ends of that string
te !hui kua ǂhom
and the string soon broke
ka !hui ku ǂhom ǁ’akaa |’Oma |’Oma tse
the string broke so that |’Oma |’Oma then

g|ae ku !aah n‡au tzi
went and ran into the bush
te ha goba
and the black man
ha goba tse kua ku !aah tsi ‡aeh khuinke he o ǁ'hai
the black man then soon ran and arrived here in the east
ha ka !oa haa, ha goba ka !oa ha te ko, "ee,
he certainly told him, the black man told him and said, "yes,
to'a u
go away
gumi sa he o gumi sa ka o mi hisi
these cows here are cows that will be mine
mi ka kxae, te a ka ku taokhomm
I will keep them and you will be ashamed
te a ka o mi gǁaakhoe"
and you will be my servant"
sa kua n‡haoh saraa khoe
they soon went their separate ways
te ha g|ae !aah u te haa goba kua !aah tsi ‡aeh
and he ran off and the black man soon ran home
ee, te ha to'a g|ae 'm tci dore sin
yes, and that one went and ate bad things
o tcisa kahinke he o n|ang he o kaqa'amakoq he o, o g!oan
these things like raisin berries, two-color raisinberries, and Kalahari raisinberries
sa |'Oma |'Oma hin ka g|ae 'm
that this |'Oma |'Oma went to eat
te ha goba ka tsi ‡aeh ge te ǁxarah
and the black man began to cultivate
ko mabare !ansi te ko camanga sin te
things like sorghum and maize and
ka ko gumi sa hin to'a te
and also these cattle and
te ka ku 'm
began to eat them
te haa |'Oma |'Oma ǁ'a ha ka g|ae u
and |'Oma |'Oma went away
te g|ae o gǁaakhoe
and became a servant
iin
yes
ee
yes

ee, ka za'a n!om tsau
yes, it's already finished
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